Shreya Chandra

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Education

University of California, Berkeley Expected 2027
Ph.D. in Agricultural and Resource Economics

Yale University 2017
M.A. in International and Development Economics

University of Delhi 2016
B.A. in Economics (Honors)

Fields

Development Economics; Labor Economics

References

Professor Jeremy Magruder
Dept. of Agricultural & Resource Economics
University of California, Berkeley
jmagruder@berkeley.edu

Professor Aprajit Mahajan
Dept. of Agricultural & Resource Economics
University of California, Berkeley
aprajit@berkeley.edu

Professor Edward Miguel
Dept. of Economics
University of California, Berkeley
emiguel@berkeley.edu

Job Market Paper

Shreya Chandra, "Irregular Labor Supply and Coordination in Firms: Experimental Evidence from India"

Abstract: Firms in developing countries face uncertainty in whether and when workers arrive at work. Such irregularity can be costly to firms, especially when production requires coordinating labor inputs. This paper tests whether and how irregular labor supply affects firms' ability to coordinate workers and firm outcomes. I run a randomized experiment with 92 manufacturing firms in India. Firms are organized as production lines. Yet, on average, three in five workers arrive after their firm's start time. Workers in treatment firms are offered a daily incentive equivalent to 20% of earnings conditional on arriving by the start time for four weeks. Incentives increase timely arrival from 41% to 59% of worker-days, driven by workers who arrived late at baseline. Worker output increases by 24% for all treatment firm workers, including those who arrived early at baseline and did not change their arrival times in response to the incentive. These spillovers from late to early workers are concentrated in firms where late workers perform tasks upstream in the production line, suggesting irregular labor supply creates hold-ups within firms. Treatment firms produce 29% more output, receive 21% more new orders and have

40% fewer delayed orders. Findings suggest that irregular labor supply hurts firm output, but coordinating worker arrival times can be costly given workers' strong preference for flexibility.

Working Papers

"Can Flexible Microcredit Substitute For Informal Finance? Experimental Evidence from Market Vendors in South India," with Natalia Rigol and Benjamin Roth.

Abstract: Informal moneylender credit remains common even where formal microfinance is widely available. We evaluate a flexible working-capital loan for market vendors in Tamil Nadu, India, in a randomized trial. The product offers formal-sector interest rates but is structured to mirror informal credit, with short tenures and borrower-chosen repayment schedules. Access substantially reduces reliance on moneylenders: treated vendors are 10 percentage points less likely to have an outstanding moneylender loan, hold nearly half as many such loans overall, and owe significantly less to moneylenders in total. They also report improved mental health, lower financial worry, and higher household income.

Work in Progress

"Input Side Constraints to Quality Upgrading among Small Enterprises," with Xavier Giné and Zixu Chen. *Funding received, pre-piloting stage.*

"Pay contracts, workplace flexibility and worker sorting," *Piloting in progress.*

"Withdrawal Fees and Digital Financial Engagement in Tanzania," with Xavier Giné, Francis Annan, and William Blackmon. *Data collection complete, analysis ongoing.*

"Politics and Public Sector Productivity," with Utkarsh Kumar. *Analysis in progress.*

Policy Writing

"Understanding Digital Financial Services Consumers in Tanzania," Tanzania Digital Financial Resilience Initiative, Innovations for Poverty Action.

"Safety Nets and the Pandemic: The State of Social Benefit Payments during COVID-19 in Bangladesh," Innovations for Poverty Action.

Grants, Fellowships, & Awards

UC Dissertation-Year Fellowship	2026–2027
Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics, UChicago ($25,000, co-PI)	2026
Hart Fellowship in Tamil Studies, Institute of South Asia Studies, UC Berkeley	2025
Structural Transformation and Economic Growth ($20,000)	2025
CEGA Development Economics Challenge, UC Berkeley ($48,000)	2023–2025
Private Enterprise Development in Low-Income Countries ($18,500)	2024
International Growth Centre, London School of Economics ($15,000)	2024
Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics, UChicago ($27,000)	2024
Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics, UChicago ($7,000, pilot project)	2024
J-PAL Jobs and Opportunity Initiative ($58,000, co-PI)	2023
SurveyCTO Primary Data Collection Grant, Honorable Mention	2023
ARE Summer Stipend, UC Berkeley	2023

Conferences & Workshops

2027 — STEG Annual Conference and Theme Workshops*

2026 — NEUDC 2026 (Cornell)*; Elisabeth Sadoulet Memorial Conference (UC Berkeley)*; Development Seminar (UC Berkeley)*; CEGA R^2 (UC Berkeley)*; ARE Seminar (UC Berkeley); PacDev (UC Davis); DevPec (Stanford); 5th AMIE Workshop

2025 — EUDN PhD Workshop (CERDI); Advances with Field Experiments (UChicago); CEGA Research Showcase, UC Berkeley; World Bank DIME–KDI School Development Impact Conference; CSWEP Mentoring Workshop

* *Scheduled.*

Teaching Experience

Data and Decisions, UC Berkeley Haas (MBA)	Fall 2022, 2024, 2025, 2026
Ethics and Responsibility in Business, UC Berkeley Haas (MBA)	Spring 2026
International Economic Development, UC Berkeley (MDP)	Spring 2022, 2023
Development Economics, UC Berkeley (Undergraduate)	Fall 2020, 2021

Research & Professional Experience

Senior Research Associate, Innovations for Poverty Action / STC, World Bank	2023–2025
Graduate Student Researcher, Prof. Edward Miguel, UC Berkeley	2022–2025
Graduate Student Researcher, Prof. Nick Tsivanidis, UC Berkeley Haas	2021
Research Associate, Prof. Tavneet Suri, MIT Sloan	2018–2020
Research Associate, Profs. Natalia Rigol and Benjamin Roth, Harvard Business School	2018–2020
Research Associate, Evidence for Policy Design India, IFMR LEAD	2017–2018

Skills & Languages

Stata, R, SurveyCTO, LaTeX, MS Office; functional knowledge of Python and ArcGIS
Hindi (native), English (fluent)